

# Lù Chén

Participatory Research, Data Visualisation, and Media Art

Portfolio [l-lu-u.github.io/](https://l-lu-u.github.io/)

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## Education

- 2020–2025  
Espoo, Finland  
**Aalto University**  
Master of Arts in New Media, Minor in Creative Sustainability,  
Thesis “**Something that connects people: Pluralising the Nokia design archive through social remembering**”  
Bachelor of Arts in Design and Media, Minor in Information Design, Thesis “**From Workshops to Civic Life: Participatory Design in Supporting Immigrants’ Civic Engagement in Finland**”
- 2012–2016  
Singapore  
**National University of Singapore**  
Bachelor of Computing (Honours) in Information Systems.
- Jan–June 2015  
Istanbul, Turkey  
**Sabanci University**  
Exchange studies, Computer Science and Visual Arts
- July 2017  
Kyoto, Japan  
**Doshisha University**  
Summer school, Japanese Language and Culture Studies

## Work Experience

- Jan 2026–present  
Helsinki, Finland / Hybrid  
**Media Lab Onto**  
**Co-Founder, Participatory Research & Design Strategy**  
Co-founded Onto, a media lab, conducting exploratory research, development, and artistic projects regarding digital archiving and AI ethics for news media, GLAM institutes, and public sector.
- Nov 2025–Feb 2026  
Helsinki, Finland  
**Demos Helsinki**  
**Junior Expert**  
Coordinated research activities for international projects, conducted qualitative data analysis and visualisation, and designed participatory activity for Demos20 anniversary event.
- 2023–2026  
Espoo, Finland  
**Aalto University**  
**Research Assistant**  
**Nokia Design Archive** - Designed and developed interactive data visualisation and digital archival portal;  
**RISE Network** in Fashion & Textile - Visualised the doctoral network and the literature review;  
**Happy Hour Machine** - **Department of Art & Media** teaching staff workload visualiser.
- 2024–2025  
Espoo, Finland  
**Teaching Assistant**  
Facilitated BA students’ learning in understanding research in the fields design and media, advised the development of BA thesis research plan
- Oct–Dec 2022  
Helsinki, Finland  
**ATARCA EU**  
**Research Assistant**  
Produced educational video “Food futures: Learning by Doing”, finalist of the **World Commons Week Teaching Video Contest**
- 2016–2020  
Singapore  
**Titansoft Pte Ltd**  
**User Experience Designer**  
Led the internal git-based design system project to improve knowledge management across three offices;

## Honours & Awards

2023 & 2025, International

### Information is Beautiful Awards

#### Short List (2025)

Project “**Nokia Design Archive**”

#### Long List (2023)

Project “**Immigration in Finnish Election: An analysis on voting machine data**”

2018, Singapore

### Adobe x General Assembly Creative Jam

#### Best Experience Design Award & People’s Choice Award

Prototype of digital service “**SoilMate: Inter-generational Solidarity through Urban Farming**” for “creating thriving neighbourhoods in Singapore”

2015, Singapore

### Montage Photography Award First Prize in Youth Category

Photo titled “**An Extended Moment**” for the competition themed “Reminiscence”, exhibited in Objectifs, Centre for Photography and Film

2011, Singapore

### Singapore Tertiary Chinese Literature Awards

#### Lianhe Zaobao Gold Award

Novella “**In Memory of My Friend Zhou Xiaofu**” received the Lianhe Zaobao Gold Award of the batch, published on the newspaper’s special issue

## Languages

- Chinese** native / bilingual  
**English** native / bilingual  
**Japanese** JLPT N2  
**Finnish** A2~B1

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## Publications & Exhibitions

- Nov 2025 **WiderScreen**  
Reunanen, Markku, Adela Lujza Lučenič, Petra Noppari & Lù Chén. 2025. "External, Integrated and Digital Personalization: How the Mobile Phone Became Unique". WiderScreen Ajankohtaista. <https://widerscreen.fi/numerot/ajankohtaista/external-integrated-and-digital-personalization-how-the-mobile-phone-became-unique/>
- Dec 2025 **ARCHIVIO Magazine**  
Chén, Lù, & Minna Hölttä. 2025. "Aalto University Opens Access to Nokia's Design Heritage"
- Sep–Oct 2025  
Espoo, Finland **Design for Cooler Planet**  
**Marsio, Aalto University**  
Exhibition and interactive activity design for the Nokia Design Archive project
- Aug–Sep 2025  
Imatra, Finland **"Välillä Väärässä" Group Exhibition**  
**Imatran Väärätalo**  
Participatory art **"Löytötavarat/Lost & Found"** on personal and communal memories with Vera Rantamaa
- July 2025  
Helsinki, Finland **Panoramic Unapologetic Kinetic Embodiment**  
**Asbestos Art Space**  
Mixed media exhibition on panoramic photography with Vertti Luostarinen
- June 2025  
Espoo, Finland **Visualizing Knowledge**  
**Aalto University**  
Lightening talk on archival visualisation, showcasing 3 data art and information design projects
- Feb 2025  
Tallinn, Estonia **DIGHT-Net workshop: Building the Digital Archive of a Scholar**  
**Tallinn University**  
Chén, Lù. 2025. "Building Nokia Design Archive: Weave with records and lived experience in information design", [seminar presentation]. Tallinn University.
- Oct 2024  
Helsinki, Finland **Aavistus x Off The Wall**  
**Helsinki City Museum**  
Generative, audiovisual data art **"Sonic Fetus / 阵痛"**
- Aug–Sep 2024  
Helsinki, Finland **Book Launch "Here, Not"**  
**Suomenlinna HIAP Gallery Augusta**  
Designed and contributed to publication **"Here, Not"** by curator Micol Curatolo, investigating how arts and culture address belonging, identity and access in the urban spaces of Helsinki.
- Jun-Aug 2015  
İstanbul, Turkey **"Studies on Photobook" Group Exhibition**  
**Gallery Mixer**  
Artist book **"Echo/回响"**

## Cultural Work & Advocacy Activities

Feb–Mar 2026, Espoo, Finland

### EMMA | Espoo Museum of Modern Art

#### Art & Craft Workshop Facilitation

Designed and facilitated craft workshops with designer Burak Türköz for the Lunar New Year Open Art Workshop and Children's Museum Festival

Jan 2026–present, Espoo, Finland

### Media Lab Library Project

#### Catalog Management

Registering and cataloging books and audiovisual materials for the community library of Helsinki Media Lab, physically located at Aalto University

Sep 2025, Espoo, Finland

### Kolibri Festivaali

#### Art & Craft Workshop Facilitation

Designed and facilitated workshop **"A Lantern for Wishes"** with designer Burak Türköz, focusing on open design and reusability of material, see documentation: <https://l-lu-u.github.io/projects/2025-a-lantern-for-wishes/>

Nov 2023–Oct 2025, Espoo, Finland

### AYY RepCo

#### Council Member for ProArte

Vice chair for ProArte from Nov 2023 until Dec 2024, focusing on international student rights and participation of arts association in student culture.

June–Aug 2023, Helsinki, Finland

### Startup Refugees x Flow Festival

#### Space & Visual Design

Designed and constructed the "Urban Oasis" tent for migrant entrepreneurs to test out business ideas at the music festival

May–Jul 2013, Kyiv, Ukraine

### AIESEC "World without Borders"

#### Volunteer Summer School Teacher

Designed and conducted 8 learning sessions about cross-cultural communication for primary and upper secondary level students